Bendamustine: Belrapzo, Bendeka, Treanda, Vivimusta

Original Effective Date: 12/5/2022
Revision Date(s): 12/5/2022; 11/7/2023; 4/25/2024; 9/24/2024; 11/4/2024; 10/1/2025
Review Date: 10/1/2025
Policy type: Medical Necessity
Line of Business: All GEHA Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

Preference	Requires Prior Auth	Drug Name	HCPCS Code	Description
Preferred	Yes	**Treanda**	**J9033**	Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride, 1 mg
Preferred	Yes	**Bendamustine 505(b)(2) Dr Reddy's**	**J9999**	Not otherwise classified, antineoplastic drugs
Non-preferred	Yes	**Bendeka**	**J9034**	Injection, bendamustine hcl (Bendeka), 1 mg
Non-preferred	Yes	**Belrapzo**	**J9036**	Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride, (Belrapzo/bendamustine), 1 mg
Non-Preferred	Yes	**Vivimusta**	**J9056**	Injection, bendamustine hydrochloride (Vivimusta), 1 mg

- Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents (or their 505(b)(2) equivalents) prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.
- Preferred product requirements apply to all requests, both new and reauthorizations.
- Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens.

Universal Approval Criteria:

Unless otherwise noted, the review criteria used by OncoHealth to determine medical necessity for anticancer treatments and supportive agents include, but is not limited to:

- National Comprehensive Cancer Network® (NCCN) - use consistent with NCCN recommendations carrying a Category 1 or 2A level of evidence; **OR**
- United States Food and Drug Administration (FDA) labeling - new drugs or regimens (combinations of drugs) consistent with the product labeling; **OR**
- Indications not included in the official FDA labeling or recommended by NCCN (Category 1 or 2A level of evidence) may be considered if determined to be medically necessary per one or more of the following compendia:
    - Clinical Pharmacology (Strong For); **OR**
    - Wolters Kluwer Lexi-Drugs® (Level A); **OR**